

Shalini Bansal

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SUMMARY

Payments product and technical lead with 11+ years at PayPal, the last four owning product direction for mobile checkout and subscriptions as squad lead for 15+ engineers. Turns ambiguous payments and reliability problems into PRDs, roadmaps and experiments with measurable outcomes. Recent independent work goes deep on Indian recurring payments. Targeting Senior PM roles in payments, subscriptions and merchant platforms.

EXPERIENCE

PayPal — Product & Tech Lead · Checkout Bengaluru · Sep 2021 – Nov 2025

Owned product direction for mobile checkout and subscriptions, leading a squad of 15+ engineers.

- **10% lift in mobile checkout conversion** — set the strategy for native checkout screens, owned the PRD and roadmap, and designed the experiments that measured impact on mobile flows.
- **10x fewer failed-payment incidents** — identified a reliability gap silently failing customer payments during database maintenance, then prioritized and led a cache-bridge fix that raised Billing Agreement reliability from 99.99% to 99.999%.
- **40M+ daily API calls migrated with zero downtime** — self-initiated a legacy monolith deprecation, aligned 10+ upstream teams on migration timelines, and sequenced cutover by merchant risk.
- **~200 merchants migrated off a subscriptions API with zero escalations** — chose the replacement path by trading off merchant effort against long-term platform value, then led segmentation, sequencing and migration comms.

PayPal — Software Engineer 3 · QR Payments San Jose · Jan 2020 – Sep 2021

Shaped product decisions for QR payment acceptance, including the Venmo payer-network expansion.

- Shaped product scope and sequencing for PayPal QR payments, translating feasibility into roadmap commitments.
- Built seller-side risk policy checks into QR acceptance, balancing fraud controls with checkout friction.
- Enabled Venmo-to-PayPal QR payments, expanding PayPal's merchant payer network.

PayPal — Software Engineer 1-2 · Incentives Bengaluru / San Jose · Jul 2014 – Jan 2020

Shipped an offers platform serving millions of users and led a zero-disruption eBay Gift Cards migration.

- Built a batch offers platform serving millions of users via high-volume file uploads.
- Owned the eBay Gift Cards migration post-split, with zero customer-facing disruption.

INDEPENDENT PRODUCT WORKS

Smart Retry & Recovery · Payments Product Spec [View case study ↗](#)

- Most platforms retry every failed recurring payment on the same fixed schedule, wasting capped retries across UPI AutoPay, card e-mandate and NACH.
- Designed a prevent → classify → retry → recover framework that retries only 3 of 7 failure classes; modeled ₹36–81L annual recovery for one 50k-subscriber merchant.

Decline Decoder · AI Product · Live Prototype [View case study ↗](#)

- Diagnoses single declines into a root cause, retry decision and message, and surfaces batch patterns (only ₹10K of ₹61K worth retrying in a sample).
- Built eval-first: 50 dev scenarios, plus 10 kept as a blind holdout. The hybrid lookup + LLM hit 98% and 100% accuracy respectively, with zero hallucinations (LLM alone: 70–74%).

Payments API Deprecation Playbook · Platform Strategy [View case study ↗](#)

- Six-step model (assess → segment → choose path → migrate → measure → sunset) for retiring a live payments API without failed payments or merchant churn.
- In an 800-merchant worked example, 18 merchants carried 78% of TPV, which is why the model segments merchants before setting any sunset date.

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Information Technology — Vellore Institute of Technology · GPA 9.10/10 Vellore · 2010 – 2014

SKILLS

Product	PRD Authorship, Roadmap Ownership, Prioritisation, Feature Scoping, Trade-off Framing, Platform Migration Strategy, Deprecation & Sunset Planning
Data & Experimentation	A/B Testing, Experiment Design, Funnel Analysis, Metric Definition, Instrumentation, Cohort Analysis, SQL
Design & Collaboration	Checkout & Merchant UX, User Flow Mapping, Design Partnership, Cross-functional Squad Delivery, Agile Ceremonies
AI & Tech Domain	LLM Application Design, Prompt Engineering, Evaluation & Guardrails, Payments, Recurring Billing & Subscriptions, UPI AutoPay & E-Mandates, Distributed Systems, API Design & Deprecation, Java
Leadership	Led 15+ engineers, Mentoring, Code & Design Review Ownership, Agile Delivery, Self-initiated Product Bets
Stakeholder Mgmt	Cross-team Negotiation (10+ teams), Merchant Communications, Executive Updates, Migration Comms, Risk & Compliance Partnership